



Nicolò Bottasso (b. 1994 in Italy, based in the Netherlands) is a violinist, trumpeter, composer and sound artist working across experimental, contemporary and folk-derived music.

His practice centres on **improvisation**, **timbre** and **repetition**, integrating acoustic instruments and live processing into an organic sonic practice in dialogue with moving image, archival material and site-specific performance. He is interested in how inherited musical languages shift when they encounter new contexts and modes of perception.

His long-standing collaboration with his brother Simone as **Duo Bottasso** has been a continuous laboratory for this practice for nearly two decades.

Since 2024, he has performed on a **tenore d'amore**, a custom sympathetic-string instrument developed with luthier Cesar Sakellarides, combining features of the baryton violin, viola d'amore and Hardanger fiddle.

Selected presentations of his projects include **Eye Filmmuseum** (Amsterdam), **LAC** (Lugano), **Deutsches Filminstitut & Filmmuseum DFF** (Frankfurt), **Nonagon Festival** (Svanö) and **MACRO** (Rome).

EDUCATION

2018 - Bachelor degree in jazz - Conservatory of Turin (Italy)

2017 - Erasmus exchange - Codarts Rotterdam (The Netherlands)

2016 - Master degree in violin - Conservatory of Turin (Italy)

LANGUAGE

Italian (mother tongue).

Fluent in french and english.

WORK EXPERIENCE

since 2012 – Freelance musician: soloist and sideman

2007 - now – Co-director, Duo Bottasso (IT / NL)

2020 - 2024 – Performer, [Gelsomina Dreams](#) (IT)

2019 - 2022 – Sideman, [Pietra Tonale Ensemble](#) (IT)

ARTISTIC INTERESTS

Folk-related, drone and minimalistic music research. Melodic and timbral improvisation. Electroacoustic digital and analog sound processing. Interdisciplinary collaborations. Audiovisual interaction. Music production, composing and arranging. Instrument development.

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Performing written or improvised music in acoustic and electro acoustic contexts. Composing and arranging music (**Sibelius**). Digital processing of sounds (**Ableton Live**). Group coaching in music performance. Ensemble music arranging. Communication skills (**MailChimp**). Video editing (**DaVince Resolve**) and video mapping (**MadMapper**). Organising events.

SELECTED PERFORMANCES

Switzerland [LAC Lugano Arte Cultura](#), [Schlossmediale](#) / **Italy** [Time in Jazz](#), [MACRO Museo di Arte Contemporanea Roma](#), Museo del Cinema di Torino, [Heroes Festival](#), [UnArchive Found Footage Fest](#) / **The Netherlands** [Gaudeamus Festival](#), [Eye Filmmuseum](#), De Doelen / **Sweden** [Nonagon Festival](#) / **Germany** DFF Deutsche Filminstituut & Filmmuseum Frankfurt

COLLABORATION

The Netherlands: Het Muziek, Nils Petter Molvær, Julian Schneemann / **Italy:** Fredo Valla, Simone Bottasso, Simone Sims Longo, Paolo Baldini Dubfiles, Riccardo Tesi / **Sweden:** Rickard Eklund, Fan-Qi Wu / **Austria:** Matthias Loibner

MAIN WORKS

Tenor d'amore – research and instrument development

[Postcards from Italy](#) – international modular project combining archives, memories live music and expanded cinema

[Quartetto Loco](#) – acoustic quartet combining 12-tone writing, folk, and improvisation

[Il Cielo di Pietra](#) – performance with archival films, live electronics

ART RESIDENCIES

2025, 2026 – [Nonagon Festival](#), Svanö (SE)

2024, ongoing – [Batavierhuis](#), Rotterdam (NL)

2024 – [OSA Open Sound Academy](#), Saluzzo (IT)

2024 – [Espace Culturel](#), Chaillol (FR)

2023 – Cultures Moves Europe residence project, Wien (AU)

2022 – [Culture en Contrebande](#), Queyras (FR)

2021, 2022, 2023 – [Building Bridges](#), Ascona (CH)

SELECTED DISCOGRAPHY

2026 – [Postcards from Italy](#), Duo Bottasso

2025 – [a dozen words for six](#), Quartetto Loco

2024 – [a dozen words for seven](#), Quartetto Loco

2020 – [Il Canzoniere di Pasolini](#), LinguaMadre

2019 – [Biserta e altre storie](#), Duo Bottasso & Simone Sims Longo

2014 – [Crescendo](#) – Duo Bottasso

REVIEWS

2026 – [Eye Magazine](#)

2026 – [Folker](#) (page 30)

2026 – [Het Muziekinstrumenten Fond Magazine](#)

[More pictures here](#)